

BRAND IDENTITY GUIDELINES

Starter edition · v1.0 · October 2026 · Proposal pending sign-off

SwitchYourMode

Contents

MXDE is pronounced Mode.

The X takes the place of the O. It stands for the variable: whichever mode you switch into after your coffee. Everything in this identity follows from that one swap.

These guidelines cover the logo, colour, type and the mode system. Packaging artwork, dielines, the website, photography and campaign work follow once the identity is signed off.

Items marked **to confirm** are working assumptions from the brief, waiting on the brand team.

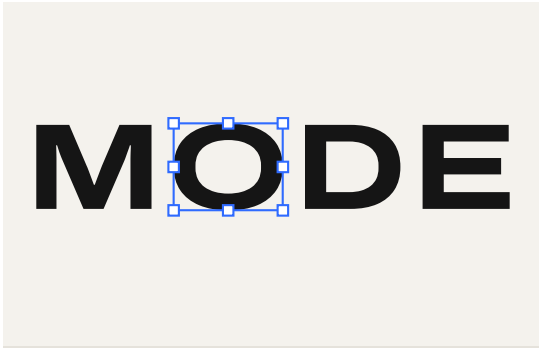
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The idea

Start from the word you want people to say, change one letter, and let that letter carry the brand. The round O becomes a square slot with an X cut into it. The slot keeps the O's place and weight, so the eye reads **Mode**. The X inside it spells MXDE and stands for the variable.



01 Start with the word people should say.



02 The O is the letter that changes.



03 Square it. A slot, not a letter.



04 Cut the X in. It reads Mode and spells MXDE.



05 Redraw M, D and E from straight lines to match.



06 Switch the slot. One brand, many modes.

Wordmark



BUILT FROM STRAIGHT LINES

Every edge runs at 0°, 45°, 60° or 90°. There are no curves in the mark. The D, the only letter with a bowl, is drawn with two 45° chamfers, so it stays a D without a round shape.

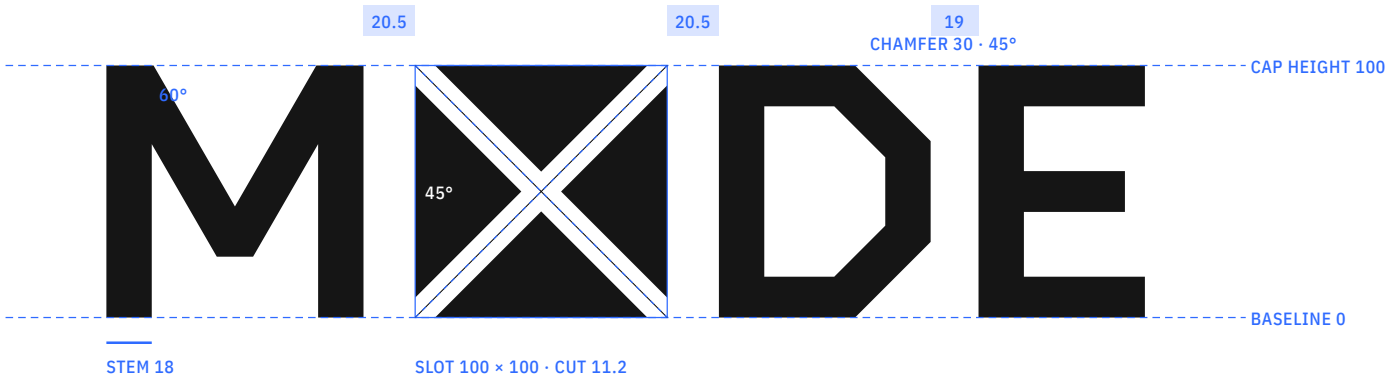
THE SLOT IS THE HERO

The slot is the only solid shape in the word. At small sizes it reads as a dark O, so the name reads **Mode**. Up close, the cut shows the X. In full colour, the slot carries the accent and M, D and E stay Carbon.

ONE WEIGHT

Stems are 18% of the cap height. Lighter weights lost the slot's mass against the letters, and heavier ones closed the D's counter at 16 px. The cut is 62% of a stem, wide enough for foil and emboss.

Construction



UNITS: CAP HEIGHT = 100. ANGLES: 0°, 45°, 60°, 90° ONLY. NO CURVES.

METRICS

Cap height	100
Stem	18
Horizontal strokes	16.2 (thinned 10% for optical balance)
Slot	100 × 100
X cut	11.2
Spacing M–X · X–D · D–E	20.5 · 20.5 · 19
Overall width	412

ROUTES EXPLORED

MXDE

MXDE

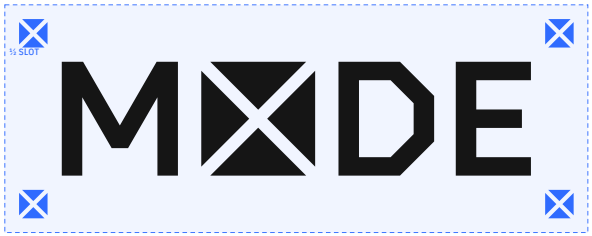
MXDE

A: Crossover. B: Slot (chosen). C: Shift. B was the only route that read as "Mode" before "M-X-D-E".

SOURCE OF TRUTH

The geometry is generated from `src/geom.py`. Change a number there, rebuild, and every file, lockup and mockup updates together. Never edit an outlined master by hand.

Clear space and minimum size



Keep clear space of half the slot's width (half the cap height) on every side. Nothing else enters that zone, including the tagline. The tagline lockup has its own fixed spacing (section 05).

MINIMUM SIZES (CAP HEIGHT)

USE	WORDMARK	MONOGRAM
Screen	16 px (66 px wide)	16 px favicon cut
Offset / flexo print	3.5 mm (14.4 mm wide)	4 mm
Foil stamp, emboss, deboss	5 mm (20.6 mm wide)	6 mm

At 5 mm cap height the X cut is 0.56 mm and a stem is 0.9 mm, inside typical foil and emboss tolerances. Confirm with the converter once sachet dimensions and finishes are known (**to confirm**).



Below 16 px, use the monogram. Below 12 px, use the favicon drawing, which has a 16% cut.

Lockups and icons



Primary. Horizontal wordmark. Use it wherever there is room.



Tagline lockup. SwitchYourMode is set in Archivo Medium at 24% of the cap height, left-aligned to the M, 42% of the cap height below the baseline. Write it as one camel-case word. Add # only where it works as a hashtag (social, packs).



Mode lockup. The mode line hangs from the X (section 12).



Monogram, app icon, favicon. The monogram is the slot on its own: for seals, stamps, the tumbler and small spaces. The app and profile icon sets the slot at 46% on Carbon, so it survives a circular crop. The favicon is the slot reversed out of a Carbon square, with a heavier cut.

Colour variants and finishes

















The sheen on the foil sample only simulates the finish. The artwork itself is always a flat, single-colour shape. On embossed or blind-debossed packs, emboss the whole wordmark at one depth. Don't sculpt the slot separately.

Misuse



✕ Don't stretch or squash.



✕ Don't rotate or slant.



✕ Don't outline the letters.



✕ Don't add shadows, glows or gradients.



✕ Don't colour M, D or E. Only the slot changes.



✕ Don't retype the name in a font.



✕ Don't put mode tiles in the slot on packs. ▲ reads MADE.



✕ Don't place on low-contrast grounds.

Colour palette

CORE NEUTRALS · LOGO, TYPE, STRUCTURE

Carbon
#151515
RGB 21 21 21
CMYK 0 0 0 95
Pantone Neutral Black C

Graphite
#4A4C4F
RGB 74 76 79
CMYK 0 2 0 80
Pantone Cool Gray 11 C

Stone
#888B8D
RGB 136 139 141
CMYK 2 0 0 52
Pantone Cool Gray 8 C

Silver
#C8C9C7
RGB 200 201 199
CMYK 0 0 1 24
Pantone 877 C (metallic foil) / Cool Gray 3 C (flat)

LIGHT GROUNDS · BACKGROUNDS, BREATHING ROOM

White
#FFFFFF
RGB 255 255 255
CMYK 0 0 0 0
Pantone — (paper white)

Paper
#F4F2ED
RGB 244 242 237
CMYK 2 2 5 2
Pantone Warm Gray 1 C at 30% tint

WARM NEUTRALS · COFFEE WARMTH, PACK GROUNDS

Oat
#E6DCCB
RGB 230 220 203
CMYK 8 10 18 0
Pantone 7527 C

Roast
#4B3D2F
RGB 75 61 47
CMYK 30 45 60 65
Pantone 7533 C

ACCENT · HIGHLIGHTS, CALLS TO ACTION

Tonic
#0E6B5E
RGB 14 107 94
CMYK 88 20 60 30
Pantone 562 C



Keep accent and mode colour to about a tenth of any layout. Pantone references are the nearest matches and CMYK values are starting points. Approve both against a Pantone guide and a press proof.

Accessible pairings

BRAND PAIRINGS

TEXT / MARK	GROUND	RATIO	AA BODY	AA LARGE
Carbon	White	18.26:1	Pass	Pass
Carbon	Paper	16.32:1	Pass	Pass
Carbon	Oat	13.45:1	Pass	Pass
Carbon	Silver	10.99:1	Pass	Pass
White	Carbon	18.26:1	Pass	Pass
Graphite	Paper	7.70:1	Pass	Pass
Stone	White	3.43:1	—	Pass
Stone	Carbon	5.33:1	Pass	Pass
Roast	Oat	7.70:1	Pass	Pass
White	Tonic	6.40:1	Pass	Pass
Tonic	Paper	5.72:1	Pass	Pass
Paper	Roast	9.35:1	Pass	Pass

MODE PAIRINGS

TEXT / MARK	GROUND	RATIO	AA BODY	AA LARGE
Wake	Paper	4.48:1	—	Pass
Active	Paper	4.22:1	—	Pass
Zen	Paper	4.42:1	—	Pass
Vital	Paper	4.22:1	—	Pass
Calm	Paper	4.38:1	—	Pass
White	Wake	5.01:1	Pass	Pass
White	Active	4.72:1	Pass	Pass
White	Zen	4.94:1	Pass	Pass
White	Vital	4.72:1	Pass	Pass
White	Calm	4.90:1	Pass	Pass

AA body = 4.5:1 for normal text. AA large = 3:1 for large text and graphics (WCAG 2.1).

RULES

Body copy, ingredients and nutrition panels: Carbon or Graphite on White, Paper or Oat only.

Stone is for captions of 18 px / 14 pt bold and above, or for rules and dividers. It isn't for body text on light grounds.

Mode colours pass 3:1 on Paper, so they work as tiles and large type. White text on a mode colour passes AA body (4.5:1), which makes buttons and chips safe. Don't set small mode-coloured text on Paper.

Never rely on colour alone. Every mode tile carries its own cut, and every mode is named in words.

WAKE ACTIVE ZEN

ARCHIVO EXPANDED SEMIBOLD · MODE NAMES, DISPLAY

The right coffee for the state you want to be in.

ARCHIVO SEMIBOLD · HEADLINES

FUNCTIONAL COFFEE · SINGLE-SERVE CONCENTRATE

ARCHIVO SEMIEXPANDED MEDIUM · SUBHEADS, NAV, BUTTONS

Tear the sachet, pour it over 150 ml of water or milk, and stir. Each mode is made for a different need at a different hour, so choose by how you want to feel next.

IBM PLEX SANS REGULAR · BODY COPY

Nutrition per sachet (18 ml) · values to be supplied	
Energy	— kJ / — kcal
Fat	— g
Carbohydrate	— g
Caffeine	— mg

IBM PLEX SANS CONDENSED MEDIUM · LABELS, INGREDIENT LISTS, NUTRITION PANELS

STYLE	FACE	SCREEN	PACK	TRACKING
Display / mode	Archivo Exp. SemiBold, caps	48/52 px	14–26 pt	+6%
Headline	Archivo SemiBold	32/38 px	10–12 pt	–1%
Subhead	Archivo SemiExp. Medium, caps	14/20 px	7 pt	+8%
Body	IBM Plex Sans Regular	16/24 px	7 pt	0
Caption	IBM Plex Sans Regular	13/18 px	6 pt	0
Label / panel	IBM Plex Sans Cond. Medium, caps, tabular	12/16 px	6 pt min.	+4%

LICENSING

Archivo (Omnibus-Type) and IBM Plex Sans (IBM) are both under the SIL Open Font License 1.1. They're free for print, web, social, apps and packaging, with no licence cost. Sources: fonts.google.com/specimen/Archivo and fonts.google.com/specimen/IBM+Plex+Sans. The wordmark itself is custom-drawn and uses no font.

SMALL-PACK LEGIBILITY

Mandatory label text has legal minimums. For example, EU 1169/2011 requires a 1.2 mm x-height, or 0.9 mm on packs whose largest face is under 80 cm². Plex Sans Condensed at 6 pt gives about 1.1 mm, so check the rules in each market you sell into (**to confirm**).

Mode system

Every mode is the same square slot, cut differently. The cut is the mode.

The X's two cuts are rearranged into a new sign for each mode. All cuts share one width (11.2 on a 100 square, 15% when the tile is drawn small), so the family stays one system. Each mode also has a tint. The tint helps, but the cut alone is enough. Every mode stays distinct in one-colour print, in greyscale and for colour-blind customers.

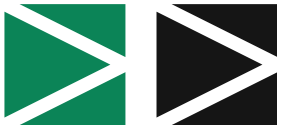
Zen and Calm. Zen's cuts stand upright: a mind that's aligned and focused. Calm's cuts lie down: a body at rest. They are perpendicular, and their tints are cool slate against warm clay.



WAKE

The X stands up — a rising peak. Mood: crisp, bright, sharp.

#2771BE · Pantone 2727 C
CMYK 78 42 0 0



ACTIVE

The X points forward — momentum. Mood: energetic, forward-moving.

#0B8457 · Pantone 340 C
CMYK 90 10 75 5



ZEN

The bars stand upright — an aligned, focused mind. Mood: still, centred, balanced.

#4F758B · Pantone 5405 C
CMYK 70 35 22 15



VITAL

The X turns upright — replenish, add. Mood: fresh, restorative, alive.

#557F22 · Pantone 7490 C
CMYK 55 10 100 10



CALM

The bars lie down — a body at rest. Mood: soft, slow, quiet.

#8C6A4E · Pantone 4645 C
CMYK 25 45 62 15

Mode lockups



FIXED RELATIONSHIP

The mode line hangs from the X. The tile's left edge aligns with the slot's left edge. The tile and the mode name's cap height are both 32% of the wordmark's cap height. The line sits 36% of the cap height below the baseline, and the name starts 32% of a tile after the tile.

In mode lockups, the slot takes the mode's tint, so the X switches into the mode. M, D and E never change colour.

Names of up to six letters end inside the E. Longer future names may run past the E but keep every other measurement.

SWITCHING IN, IN MOTION ONLY

In animation and social content, the slot can morph into a mode's tile and then return to the X. Never set a mode tile inside the wordmark on packs, the site header or anywhere the name has to be read. A slot showing the WAKE ▲ reads as "MADE".

Growing the system

A sixth or seventh mode needs no redesign: draw a new cut in the same square.

1. Use two straight cuts at the system's cut width, at 0°, 45°, 90° or along the square's diagonals and midpoints.
2. The new sign must differ from all existing ones in silhouette at 24 px, in one colour. Test it in the thumbnail grid.
3. Avoid cuts that turn the slot into a letter (▲ = A, ≡ = E) if the tile could ever sit beside the wordmark.
4. Choose a tint from the blue–green–warm-neutral families with at least 4.5:1 for white text and 3:1 against Paper. Keep it clearly apart from its nearest neighbour.
5. Name it in one word, ideally six letters or fewer.



▼ E.G. RECOVER



◀ E.G. RESET

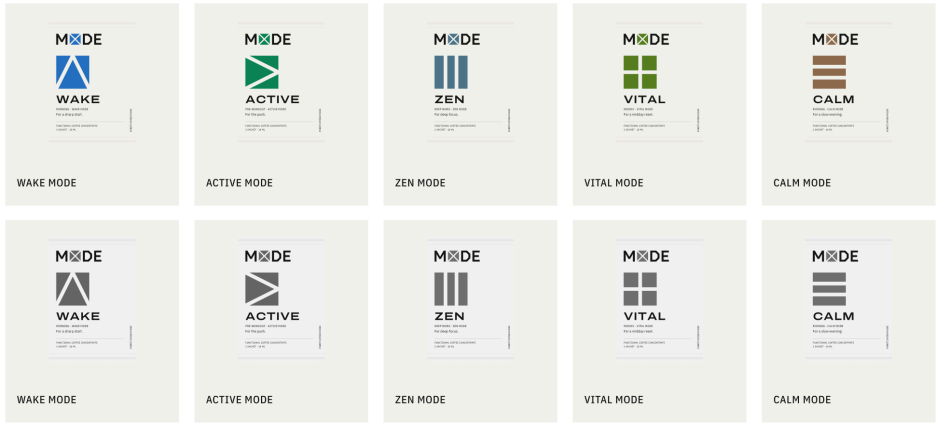


⊥ E.G. GROUND

Applications · packaging

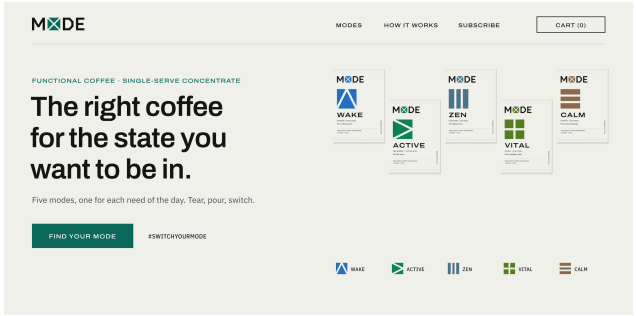






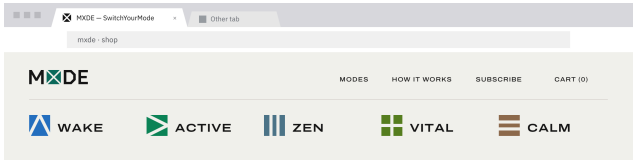
Presentation mockups, not production artwork. Sachet proportions assume a flat pouch of about 75 × 110 mm (**to confirm**).

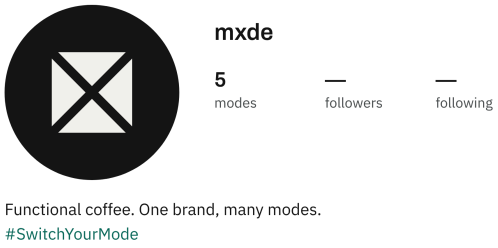
Applications · digital and lifestyle

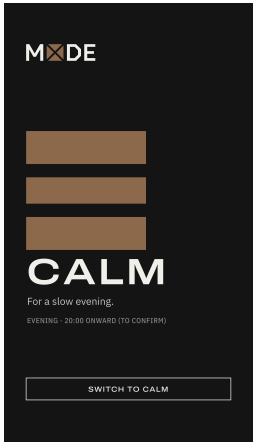














Files and handover

FOLDER	CONTENTS
logo/svg · pdf · eps · png	Wordmark and tagline lockup in full colour, carbon, black, white, tonic and silver. Monogram in carbon, white, tonic and black. PNGs are transparent, 400–3200 px wide.
icons/	favicon.svg, favicon.ico (16/32/48), PNG 16–192, apple-touch-icon 180, app icons 512 (carbon, paper, tonic), profile picture 1080, site.webmanifest, head snippet
modes/svg · pdf · png	Five mode lockups × full colour, carbon, white and reversed colour. Five mode tiles × colour, carbon and white.
colour/	mxde-palette.json (HEX, RGB, CMYK, Pantone, contrast results), mxde-palette.ase (Adobe swatches)
mockups/	All presentation mockups, PNG at 2×
src/	Editable sources: geometry, palette, build scripts, fonts (OFL), mockup and guideline generators

NOTES

Masters are outlined vector paths with no live text. The editable sources are the generator scripts. Change a value in `src/` and run `src/make.sh`.

Native .ai files: the PDF masters open directly in Illustrator. Save them as .ai there if a supplier needs the native format.

A trademark search on the name and the slot mark hasn't been done. Run one in each target market before launch.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE BRAND TEAM

- Target customer and price positioning
- Sachet dimensions and finish (matte, foil, kraft)
- Exact function and time of day for each mode
- Reference brands to admire and to avoid
- SwitchYourMode vs #SwitchYourMode. Proposed: no # in lockups, # on social and packs.
- Trademark check status
- Timeline and budget